12. Consider statement 1, which describes “Accelerated Irrigation Benefits Programme was launched during 1996-97 to provide loan assistance to poor farmers” is incorrect, such programme gives financial aid to speed up completion of uncompleted Major/Medium Irrigation which will carry Extension, Renovation and Modernisation of irrigation projects hence it will not provide loan assistance to poor farmers. Statement 2 describes “Command Area Development Programme was launched in 1974-75 for the development of water-use efficiency” which is correct as this programme improves utilisation of irrigation potential and optimising agricultural productivity along with production from irrigated areas.
13. Mekong Ganga Cooperation established on 10th November 2000 at First Ministerial Meeting in Vientiane with an idea to expand cooperation in tourism, culture, education, and transportation among India and countries of Mekong region such as Cambodia, Laos, Myanmar, Vietnam and Thailand. This statement shows that option (c) is correct as Bangladesh and China are not part of Mekong Ganga Cooperation.
14. Westerlies wind flow between 30° N and 60° N latitude to 30° S and 60° S latitude blowing from high pressure area in the horse latitude towards the pole. Now on analysing both statements 1 and 2 it can be seen see that statement 1 is incorrect as Westerlies wind flow does not blows between 30° N latitude and 60° S latitude as mentioned in the statement. This eliminates options (a), (c) and (d). Statement 2 is correct which says moist air masses cause winter rams in North-Western region of India since western cyclonic disturbances is a winter month phenomena which are carried by westerly flow from Mediterranean region that influence north and north-western weathering conditions in the regions of India which are non-monsoonal precipitation driven by Westerlies.
15. Tides are basically alternate rising and falling of sea levels that are caused mainly by gravitational pull of Moon and Sun and secondly by rotation of Earth. In case of gravitational Earth-Moon system, gravity behaves as rope which pulls two bodies together while centrifugal force is applied to keep two bodies apart. As centrifugal force is more than gravitational pull of the Moon, so the ocean